

Get the whole group to **BeThere.**

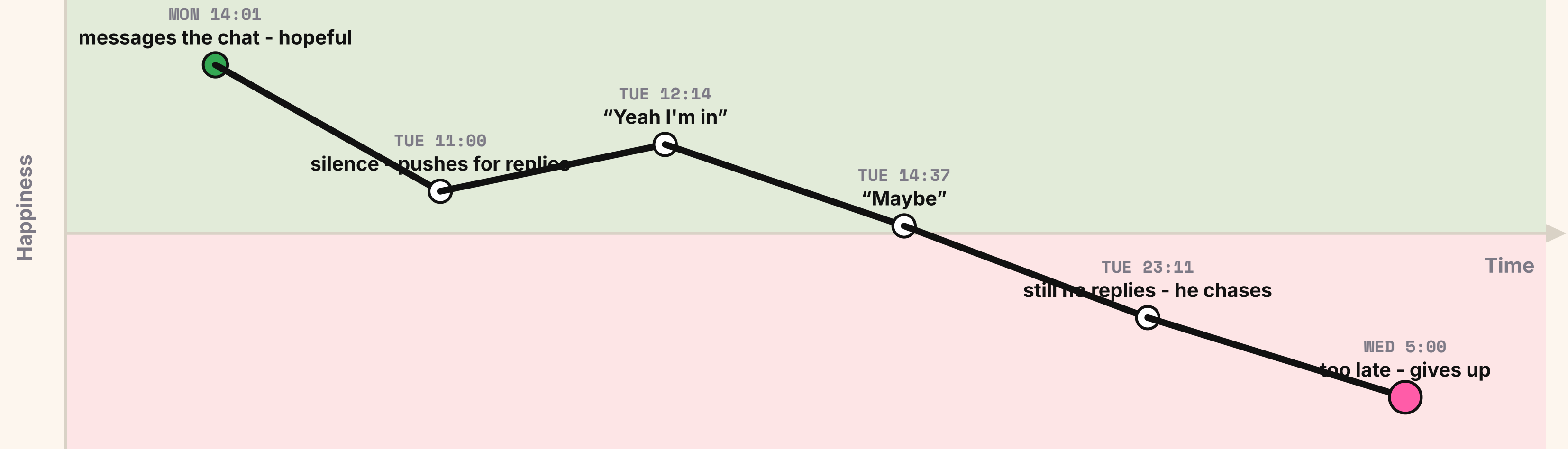
No organiser. No maybe - just the whole group, there.

Meet **Vasanth**

- Age 21
- Studies Law at St. Andrews
- Enjoys playing volleyball and board games
- Loves to cook for his friends
- Extroverted and reliable



Vasanth's pub quiz last week, mapped as he felt it

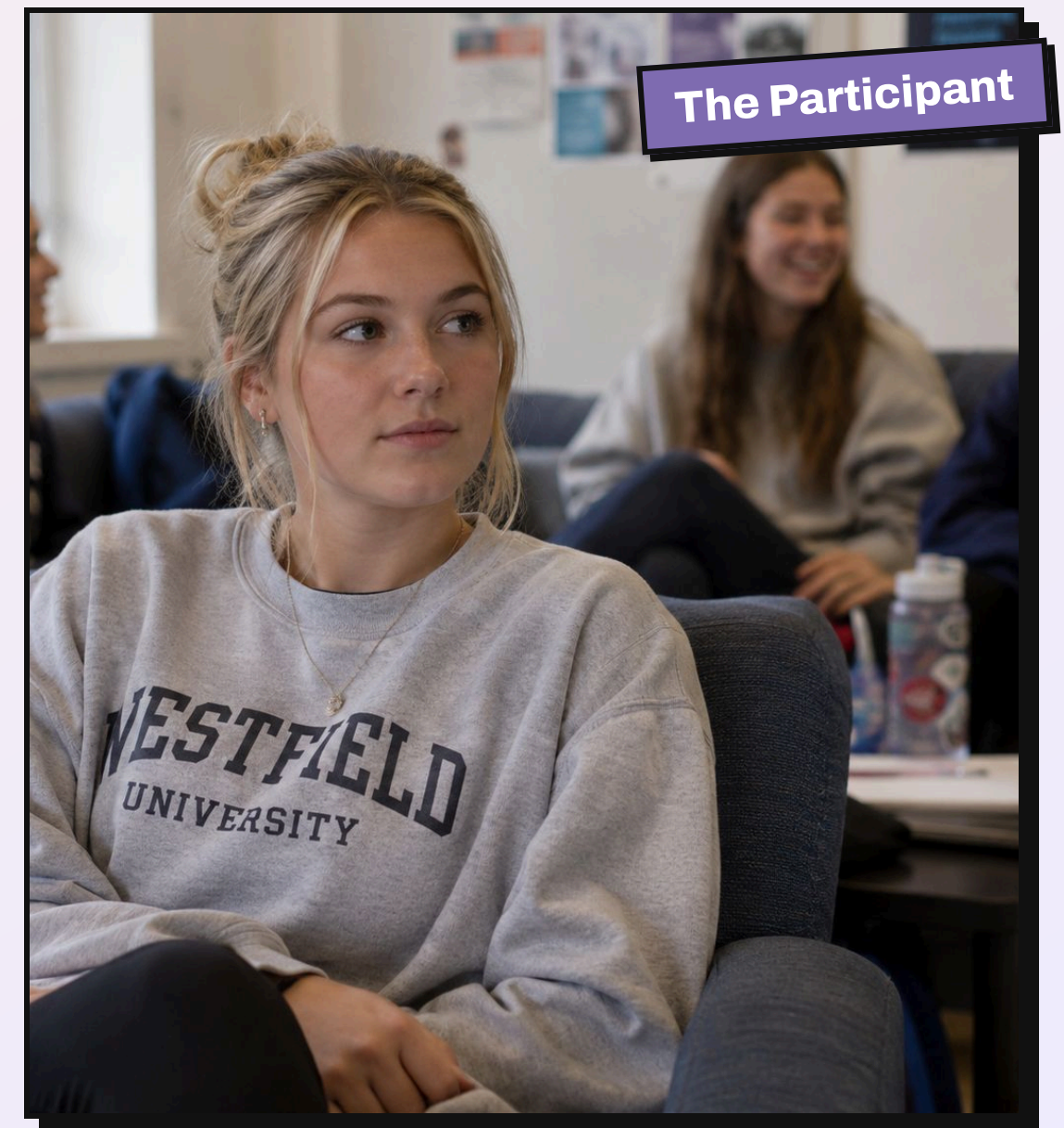


THE ORGANISER'S PROBLEM

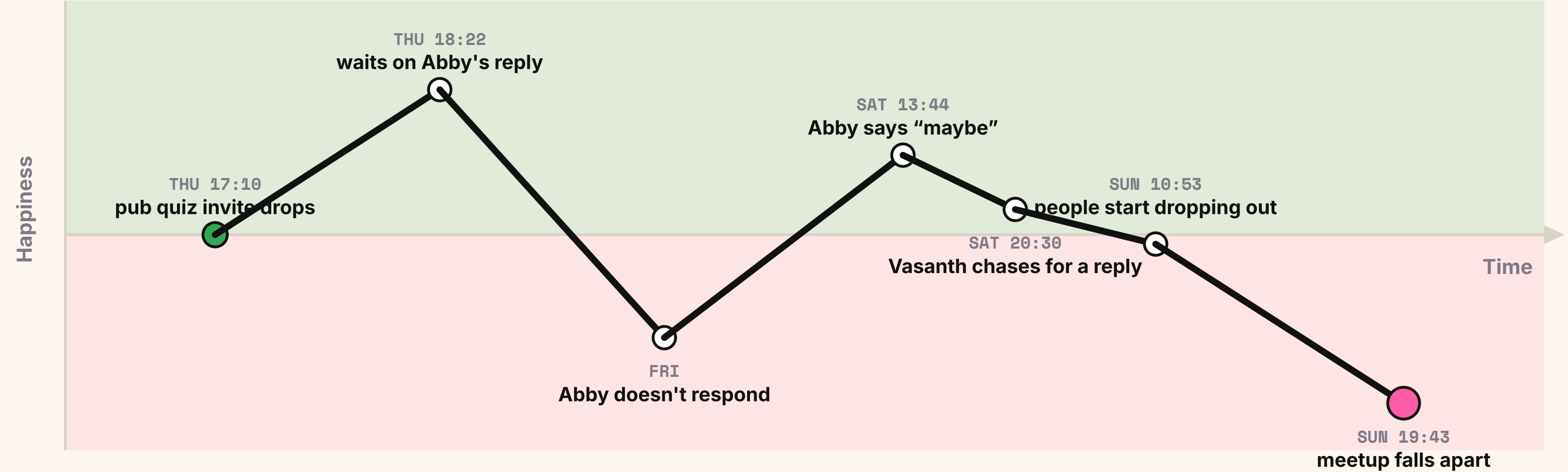
Vasanth loves to meet his friends, but organising is difficult and chasing replies from hesitant group members is frustrating.

Meet **Milly**

- Age 19
- Studies English Literature at St. Andrews
- Likes to play cello and read
- Recently joined her university's netball society
- Shy and introverted



Milly's pub quiz, mapped as she felt it



THE PARTICIPANT'S PROBLEM

**Milly would love to go to the pub quiz, but she's
hesitant - she'll only go if Abby goes, because Abby is
the only person she knows there.**

RESEARCH

To understand this problem, we interviewed
university students **about their social lives.**



Eddie, 21

Psychology · Goldsmiths

The organiser

“I do **all the work** - where we’re going, who’s paying, making sure everyone’s free - then half of them don’t even reply and it just dies. All that effort for nothing. **Does my head in.**”



Chloe, 19

Int. Relations · King's
College

The participant

“Honestly I wasn’t sure I’d go - and everyone else seemed **just as unsure**. Once a couple of people went quiet, I just figured it **wasn’t happening**.”



Luca, 20
BioChem · Oxford

The participant

“If I’m meeting a friend of a friend, my attendance is **conditional** on my friend being there. I’ll **wait for them to respond first**, then decide.”

Two key stakeholder **groups**

1. ORGANISERS

One sided and exhausting. *Awkward* to push for replies.

2. PARTICIPANTS

Uncertainty *compounds* uncertainty. Some people's participation is *contingent* on others.

70%

less time 15-24s spend with friends in person than two decades ago.

US Surgeon General • 2023

40%

of UK 16-24s feel lonely often or very often - the loneliest age group.

BBC Loneliness Experiment • 2018

25%+

of lonely young people have sought therapy.

BACP • 2025

We surveyed 47 people about how they plan meet-ups.

87%

send a "maybe" or delay their reply to a plan they are unsure about.

60%

say the meet-up time gets moved half the time or more.

50%+

say over a third of their meet-ups never make it out of the chat.

OPPORTUNITY - HOW MIGHT WE

How might we reduce **hesitancy in undergraduate friend groups when planning to meet up so that groups go from frustrating **'maybe'** responses to a clear **consensus**?**

User Story

As a social member of my friend group who tends to organise things

I want to be able to easily suggest meetups to my friends

So that I can see my friends more without the frustration of chasing responses



Our initial design

Suggesting a meet - what we tried, and what testers told us

TRY 1 · SUGGEST A MEET

<

Suggest a meet

GROUP

Lithuanian Study Group

Climbing Group

TITLE

Bouldering

LOCATION

Vauxwall East

DATE

2026-06-10

TIME

14:00

Create

Meetups

Groups

Account

“I could see this being used to just check for people's availability - sending out a vague idea of ‘I want to meetup’ and seeing what everyone wants to do.”

“Having a set time seems quite restrictive - it would be nice to agree on a time within the group.”

TRY 2 · FLEXIBLE VS FIXED TIME

20:05

<

Suggest a meet

LOCATION optional

TenPin Bexleyheath

NOTES optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

WHEN

Flexible

Fixed

Offer a time or two; people react and it locks at a deadline.

Tomorrow eve

This Sat

Sat eve

Next week

Thu, Jun 4

10:15 PM

+ Add a time

LOCKS IN

Locks Wed 3 Jun, 22:15

the evening before - best-supported time wins

Change

Float it

Add a title to continue

Meetups

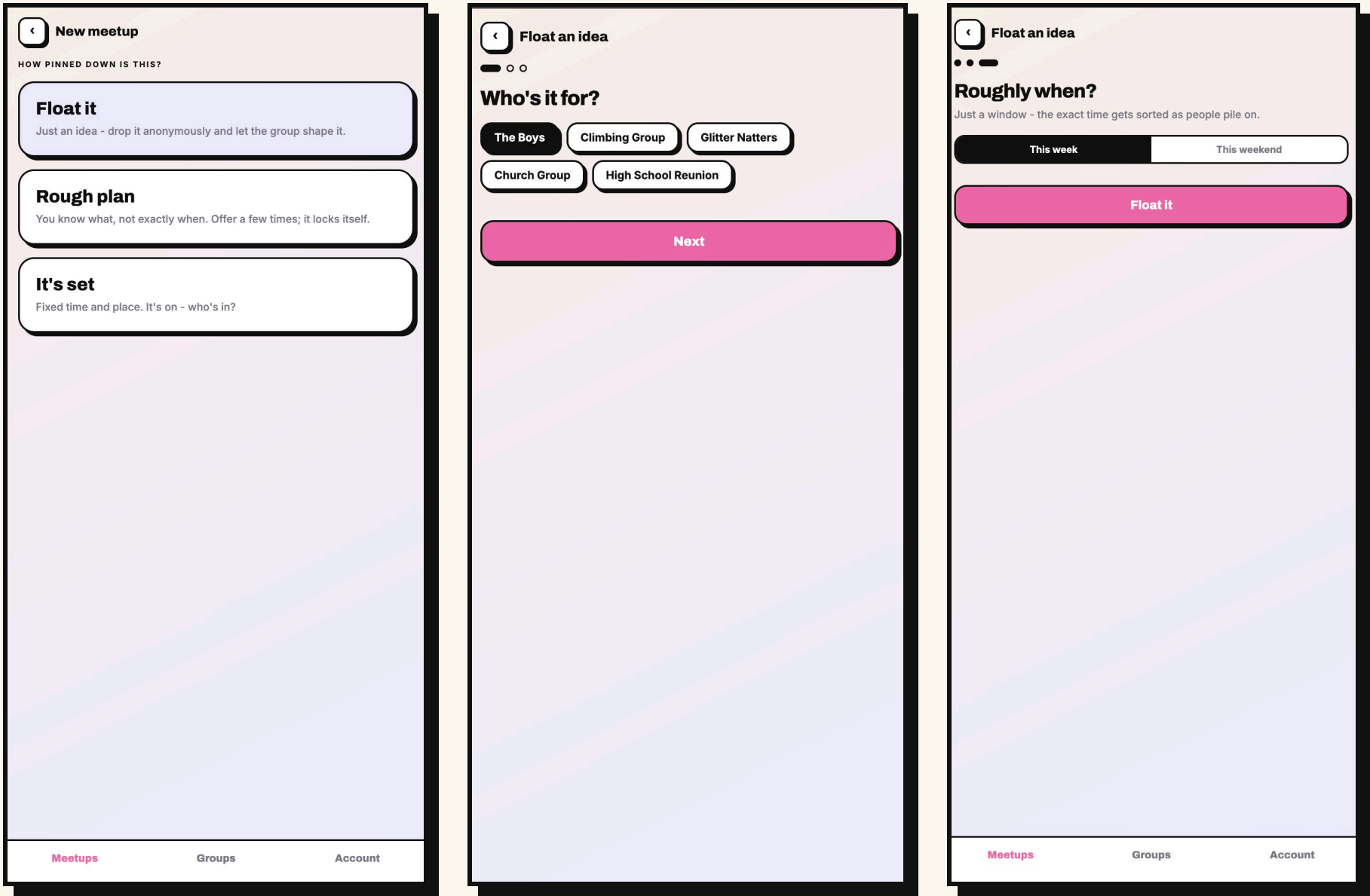
Groups

Account

“It's not immediately obvious why there's a flexible and fixed option for times.”

→ So we cut the modes down to two simple switches.

After some refinement



“
These options are quite confusing - I don't really understand when you would ever use the rough plan option.
- Aisha, 2nd year

User Story

As a new and introverted member of a friend group

I want to only attend social events if I already know people going

So that I don't feel out of place



Initial mock-up

Conditional attendance - "I'll go if..."

28th May 2026

Bowling TenPin Bowling
16:00 Bexleyheath

I will make it

I won't make it

I will make it if...

Joe

AND

...

OR

...

are going
I confirm

28th May 2026

Bowling TenPin Bowling
16:00 Bexleyheath

I will make it

I won't make it

I will make it if...

Joe	☐
Bethan	☐
Adi	☒
Lily	☒
Nathan	☐

at least one of all of

are going

CONFIRM

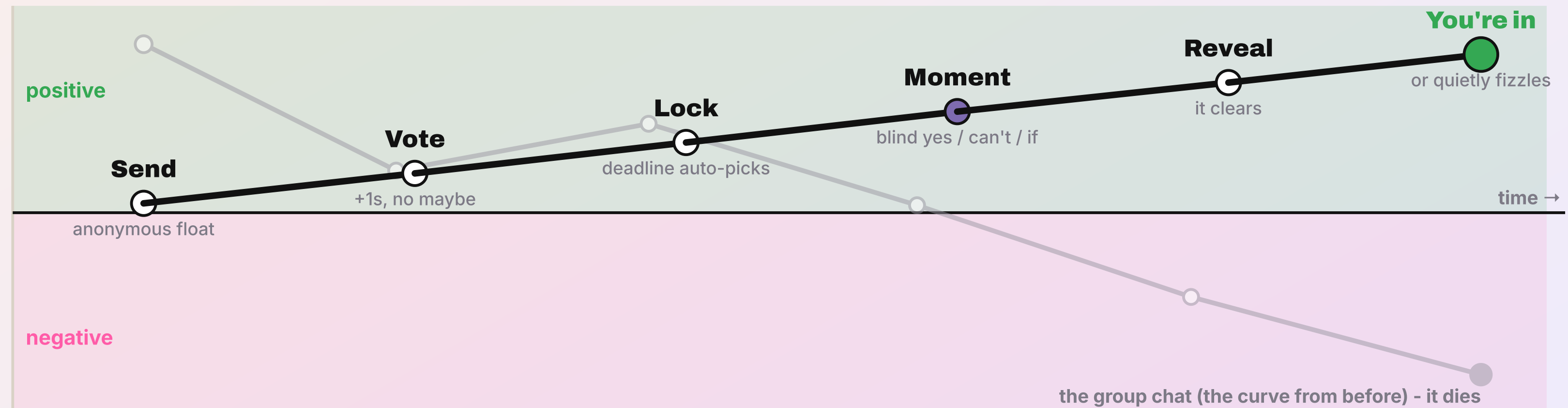
"It's either I'll go if one person goes, or if a group of people go. I don't think I'd need something this complex."

"There's gotta be an and/or type thing with the ifs - I'll go if Adi and Lily are going, or if either of them are going."

"These two options are definitely the things I'll be thinking about if it were a meeting where I'd conditionally go."

And the curve **inverts**

Same Friday, same friends. The faint line is Vasanth's journey from before - the same plan in the group chat. BeThere inverts it.



User Story

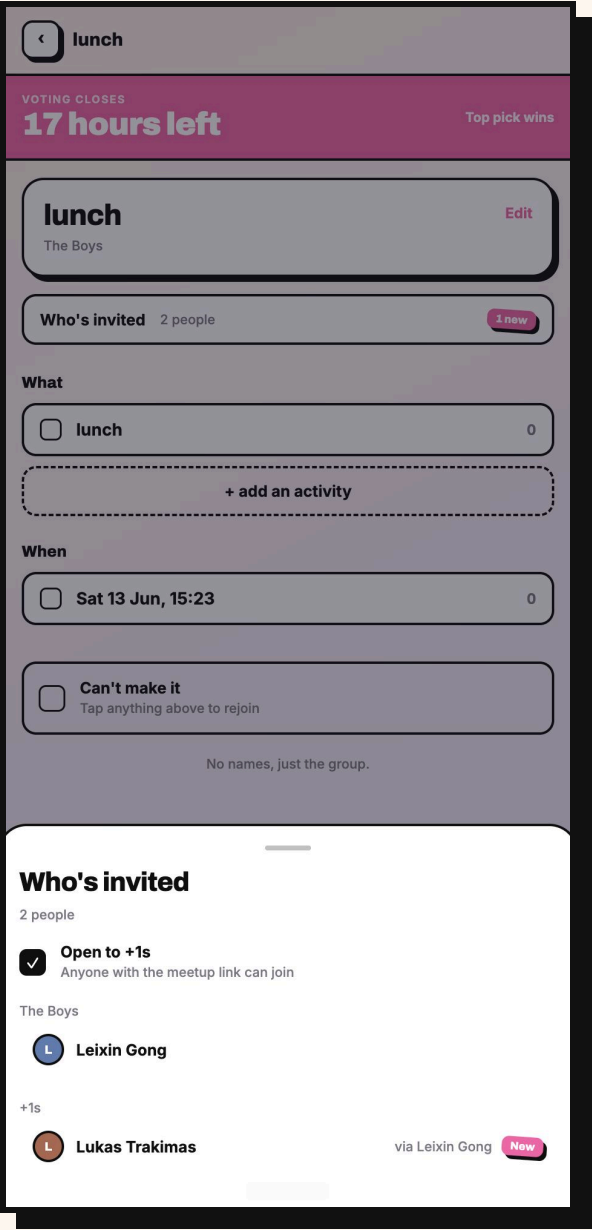
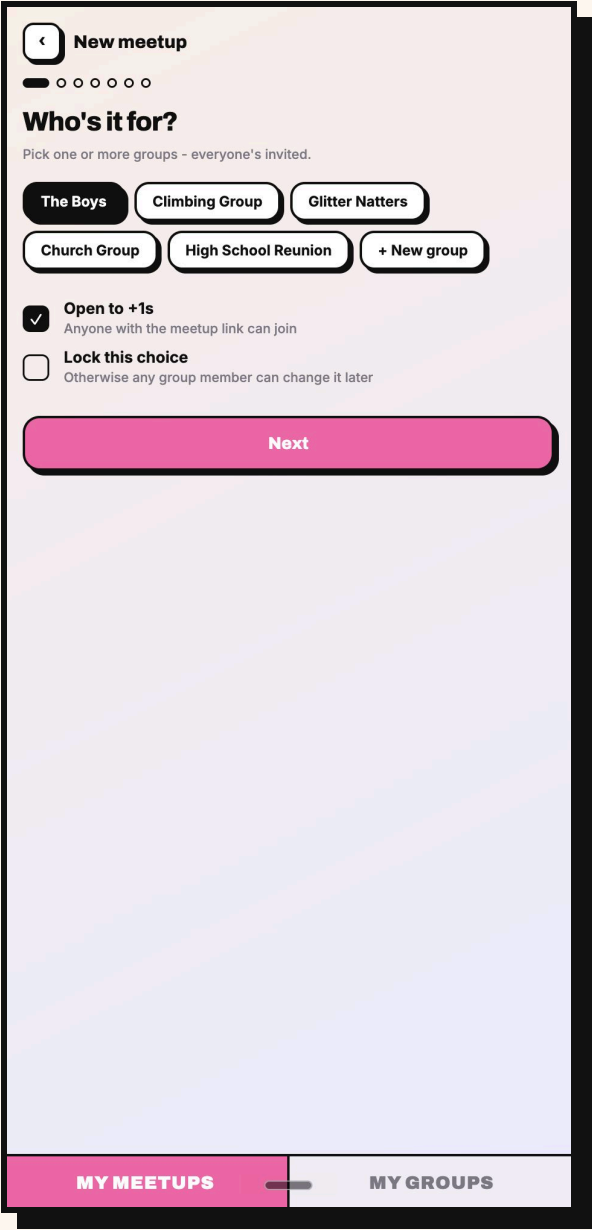
As a student in numerous friend groups

I want to suggest meetups bringing together several groups of people, and to allow friends to bring along their friends

So that I can invite people I don't know who would improve the event



After some refinement



“

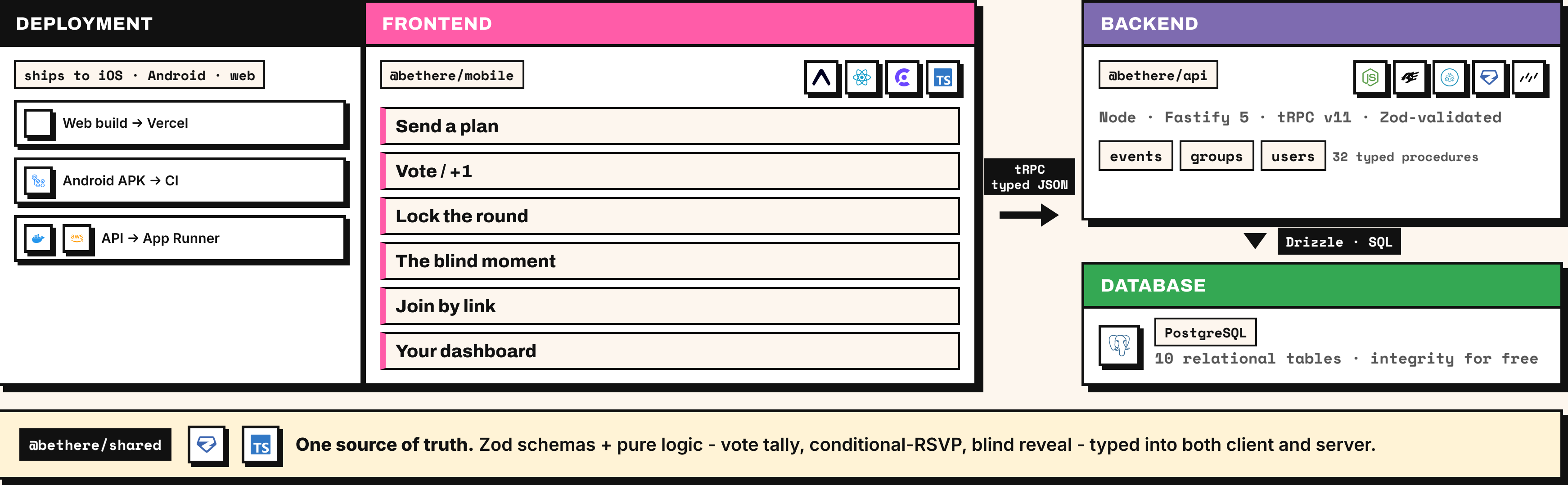
Going to a group event is a lot about the chemistry between the group. If someone was there I didn't really know, it might ruin that.

- Daniel, 3rd year

Implementation

Under the hood

One typed pnpm monorepo • TypeScript end to end



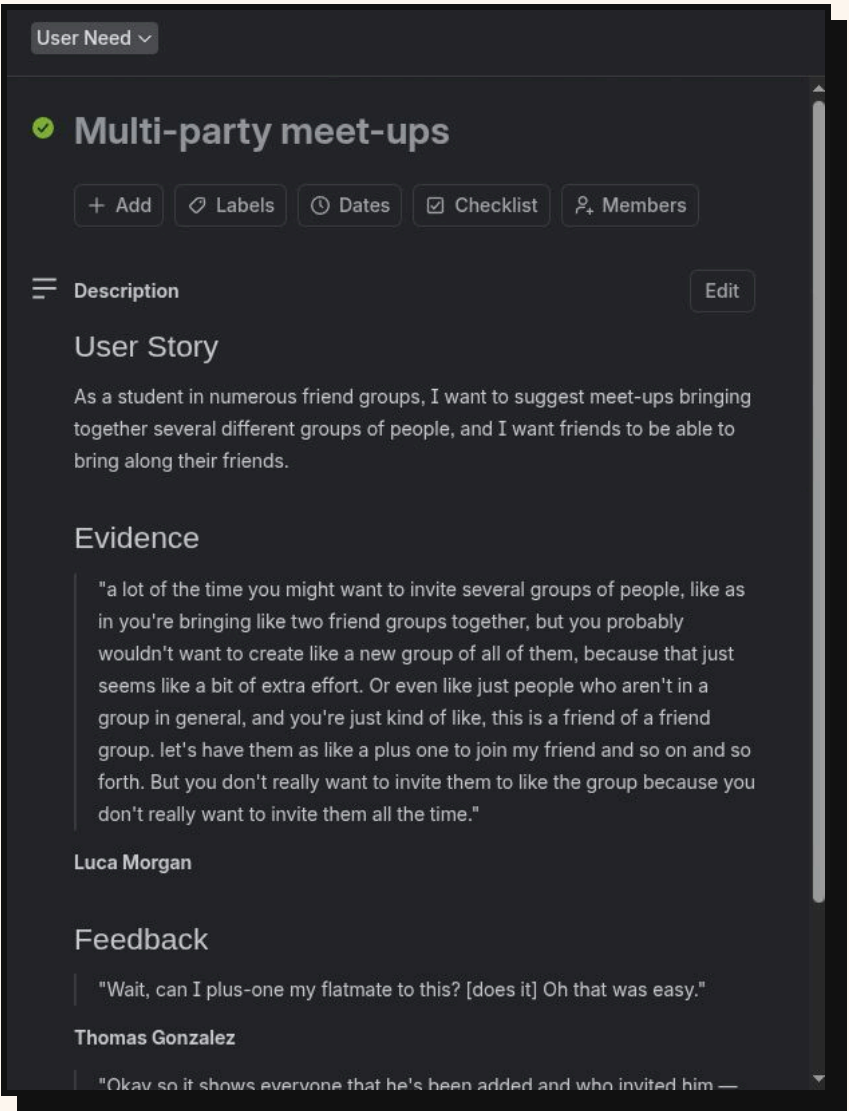
press → to walk through each layer ↓

What went well

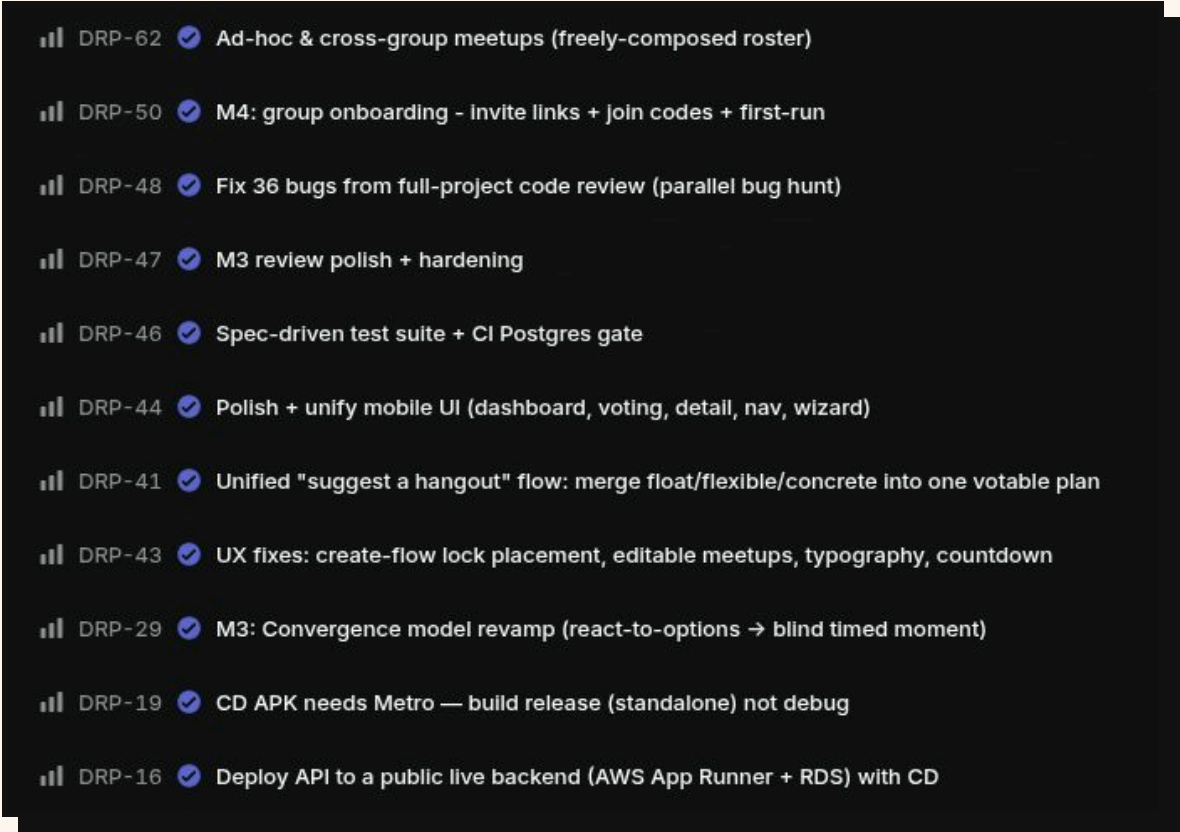
Continuous feedback from new and recurring users gave us diverse insight.

Real friends planning real meetups surfaced the app's actual pain points.

Agile development



Trello for mapping user needs.



Linear for engineering issues.

What we would do differently

Testing: a stronger test suite would have stopped bugs recurring.

Sprint planning: we built around features - user stories came too late.

Impact

User impacts & **benefits**



Vasanth

- ✓ Goes out with his friends regularly, despite his busy schedule.
- ✓ Feels less lonely.

Milly

- ✓ Is more comfortable with meeting new people.
- ✓ Has begun suggesting meetups of her own.

Wider **impacts**

MENTAL HEALTH

University counselling services

PUBLIC HEALTH

NHS mental health provision

COMMUNITY

University societies

LOCAL ECONOMY

Local venues

LOOKING AHEAD · 01 / 03

Milly's availability may change after confirming she'll **BeThere.**

People who will go **if Milly goes** want to be notified she might not make it.

LOOKING AHEAD • 02 / 03

Plus-ones are still an **awkward problem.**

Vasanth may welcome plus-ones to his meetup, but there are some people he would **prefer not to see there.**

LOOKING AHEAD · 03 / 03

Meetup logistics are full of nuance, we cannot capture every case.

An **in-app chat** dedicated to the meetup, available after confirmation, would let the group settle the details.

BeTThere.